

European People's Party
MANIFESTO for the
European elections 1994

The European People's Party is a *transnational* party with a federal structure that groups together the Christian-Democrat and people's parties of the Member States of the European *Union*. In their task of *building* Europe, the EPP Members of the European Parliament who are given a mandate by the people of Europe in the June 1994 elections, undertake to uphold the objectives set out in this manifesto, in line with the commitment of the EPP, its member parties and its representatives at all levels to advance resolutely towards European *unification* in accordance with the action programme for the next session of the European Parliament (1994,-1999), which was approved by the tenth EPP Congress under the title 'Europe 2000 - Unity in Diversity'.

Priorities

Our policy priorities are combating unemployment, securing economic recovery, *cleaning* up the environment, guaranteeing internal security and ensuring peace and they can be achieved only in the framework of the European Union.

Our objective is a Europe of human dimensions that responds to its people's needs. We want a Europe that is good to live in, where men and women can fulfil themselves in full equality and freedom. We want to offer hope to young people and create an *environment* of well-being for their seniors.

A strong economy

We want a Europe *endowed* with a strong economy that guarantees employment. Consequently we want an economic policy based on the principles of the social market economy. The spirit of enterprise and competition must be strengthened. Economic *and* social cohesion between the regions of Europe must be promoted. Small *and* medium-sized undertakings must be encouraged.

We believe that Economic *and* Monetary Union is an essential factor in guaranteeing stability and prosperity in the European Union, which is why we insist that the member countries fulfil the criteria of low *inflation*, rigorous budgetary discipline, stable exchange rates and *harmonization* of interest rates in the long term. A single European currency would reinforce the

internal market and permit fair and fruitful competition. The independence of the European Central Bank and its commitment to stability are important guarantees for a sound European currency.

Development of the social dimension and protection of the environment

We are convinced that the European Union would be incomplete without the social dimension and consequently we are in favour of the implementation of the European Social Charter. Cooperation between the two sides of industry is an important factor in implementing policies against unemployment, especially among young people and women, and creating new jobs.

We are committed to a social market economy that also respects the environment. One of the main challenges in the years to come, in addition to the creation of jobs and expansion of the social dimension, is the protection and cleaning up of the environment. Environmental protection and the social market economy do not run counter to one another: they complement each other.

Ensuring internal security

The European Union has considerable responsibilities in the field of internal security, which means the security of the people of Europe. Drug trafficking, terrorism and other kinds of crossborder crime can only be combated effectively by police cooperation at European level.

We support the creation and development of EUROPOL and are in favour of all measures which guarantee the internal security of the Union, such as European cooperation between national security services, adoption of European rules allowing police to pursue criminals and intervene in neighbouring frontier regions and European standards for controls at the Union's external borders.

„We demand the regulation of conditions of entry for non-Community nationals, the granting of visas, legal assistance and extradition procedures as a matter of urgency.

A common approach to immigration

The pressure of migration flows from all quarters represents a major challenge to the Member States and the people of Europe.

We want a common immigration policy capable of preventing the undesirable consequences of clandestine entries and the abuses to which illegal immigrants are subjected.

We want to harmonize the right of asylum for political refugees.

We want Community regulations on the temporary reception of refugees from regions affected by civil war.

We want aid programmes that remove the reasons for emigration in the countries of origin.

We are committed to the fight against exclusion, racism, xenophobia and *discrimination*. The quality of European society depends on its capacity for integration.

An open and interdependent Europe

We advocate an open and interdependent Europe that will contribute to world peace. We are committed to an international order that guarantees respect for human rights everywhere and establishes procedures and rules to resolve conflicts in a peaceful and civilized manner.

We recognize that aid for developing countries and the fight against hunger and poverty are important tasks for the rich countries. We want to cooperate with the poor countries to help them help themselves. Consequently we are committed to the opening up of the world's markets to Third World products and for untied aid for education and training.

We want the European Union as one of the world's leading trading powers to make an active contribution to promoting international trade in goods, services and capital on the basis of the GATT system and to encouraging GATT's development towards a genuine international trade organization that guarantees the same rules for everyone. International trade must increasingly operate in a framework that ensures respect for social welfare and environmental standards.

We want to enlarge the European Union to incorporate countries that apply for membership, accept the *acquis communautaire*, the Treaty of Union and its objectives and that fulfil the necessary conditions: respect for human rights and minorities, constitutional democracy, and operation on a sound economic footing that will permit integration. Increased Community cooperation by improvement of the Union's institutional and political system is a precondition for enlargement.

Peace and security

As Europeans we must assume greater responsibility for our external security and for maintaining peace in Europe, in the framework of the Atlantic partnership. The need to be able to respond has been highlighted by the United Nations' inability to prevent aggression and genocide in Bosnia.

Peace, democracy and economic and social development in the neighbouring regions - the Mediterranean, Central Europe and the Balkans - are the fundamental objectives of the European Union.

We want European security to form an integral part of the Union's objectives; the institutions concerned must develop a common security and defence policy. We recognize that NATO and the CSCE are essential in guaranteeing our security. Nevertheless, the European Union and its security arm, the WEU, have to be able to operate independently if this proves necessary to maintain security and peace in Europe.

A democratic constitution

Our objective of creating a Europe that works effectively, that is aware of its mutual interests, democratic, close to the people, less bureaucratic and less centralized has not yet been realized. We therefore have to begin drafting a European constitution now and preparing for the intergovernmental conference of 1996 that will have the task of completing the Treaty on European Union.

The future European constitution must be based on three fundamental principles: subsidiarity, effectiveness and democracy.

The principle of subsidiarity provides a guarantee of a Europe close to the people and of national or regional diversity. Only issues that cannot be resolved at national and regional level will be settled at European level, thus preserving and furthering the identity, the culture and the way of life of all the peoples of Europe.

The principle of effectiveness concerns the Union's capacity to resolve specific problems of public concern, which the Member States are no longer capable of dealing with. This requires a reliable, balanced institutional system equipped with simple decision-making procedures and responsibilities that are clearly divided between the various levels.

The democratic principle guarantees the fundamental rights of peoples and transparent decision-making procedures, which the public understand and in which they can take part. This means that real supervisory and legislative powers must be vested in the European Parliament, in which the people's representatives sit.

The European Union provides the soundest Guarantees for our future

It is only by unity that Europe can assure its future and it is only by a federal, decentralised structure that the European Union can guarantee respect for the diversity of national and regional identities and at the same time initiate the common effort that is needed if we are to solve the problem of the future of Europe.

Our countries' internal peace, our security, the stability of our political system and our prosperity depend on the lasting success of the European Union and its policy - not only for us, who are fortunate enough to be able to live in the Union, but also for the Europeans of Central and Eastern Europe, towards whom we have a duty of solidarity on historical grounds.

we, the members of the European People's Party, have decided to move resolutely forwards in furthering the process of European unification and integration. This is the only way of guaranteeing security, prosperity, freedom and peace - for today and tomorrow.

Adopted by the EPP political bureau in Brussels on 3 February 1994.